

the question. But if you want to retire on \$743 a month, you need only three special rules:

Live overseas or live in the United States like a student

Search out moneymaking sidelines

Focus on spending priorities

LIVE OVERSEAS OR LIVE IN THE UNITED STATES LIKE A STUDENT

Chapter 5 says that when you retire you should rent or buy living space in North Carolina, Kentucky, Tennessee, or Georgia. Once you're set up in one of those places, you can spend part of the year overseas. With \$400,000 or \$500,000 you can afford both to maintain a place in the Southeast and to cover travel costs abroad. On \$743 a month, you can't.

OVERSEAS LIVING

For bare-bones retirement, your best bet is to sell your home, stick the proceeds in bank CDs, stuff your household goods in someone's garage, and beat it to Guadalajara, Rio de Janeiro, or Madrid. Forget about maintaining a residence in the Southeast. Instead, close up shop in the United States as completely as you can. When you leave, take only your clothes, hobbies, and those personal effects that serve as future shock absorbers, like a coffee cup, set of dominoes, and favorite silk tie.

Why Guadalajara, Rio de Janeiro, or Madrid? I think most retired Americans would find it fairly easy to adjust in those three cities. All three have large American communities that welcome newcomers. All three have an American Club, English-language newspapers, and American bookstores. And all three are wonderful, upbeat places to live. Heading overseas with a one-way ticket is bound to seem scary. Give